



PonyABC Desktop

User Guide

Books, recordings and pen updates — made simple.

For the PonyABC P5 reading pen · App version 0.3.17 · September 2026

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The newest version of this guide is always at ponyabc.co.uk. If your app looks a little different, you probably have a newer version — lucky you!



1

Getting started

Hello! PonyABC Desktop helps you look after your P5 reading pen. It puts new books on the pen, keeps a safe copy of your child's recordings and keeps the pen itself up to date. You don't need any technical know-how.

Install the app

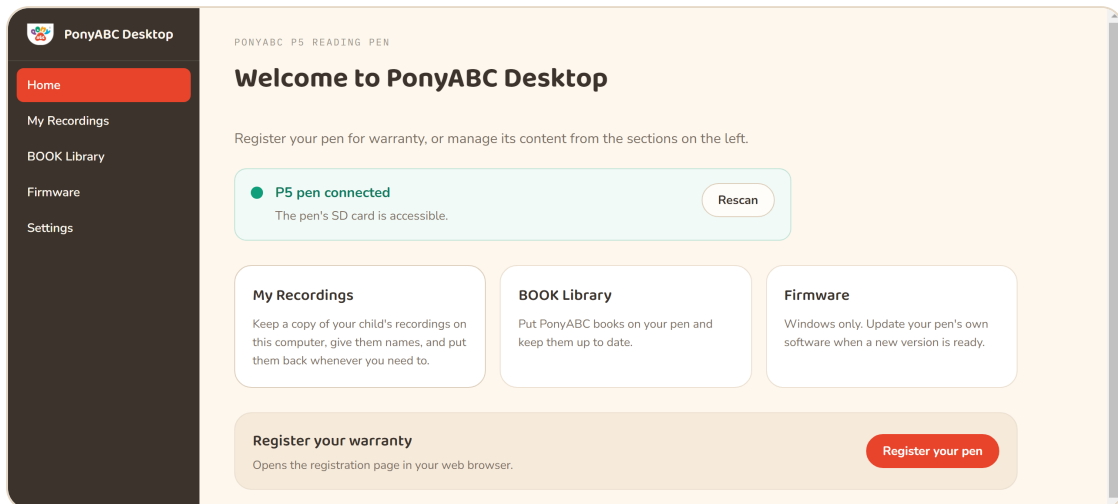
1. Open the **Microsoft Store** on your Windows computer.
2. Search for **PonyABC Desktop**, or scan the code.
3. Select **Get**, then **Open**. There's nothing else to set up.



Microsoft Store

Connect your pen

Plug the pen into your computer with the **USB cable** that came with it. Bluetooth on its own isn't enough: the pen needs to show up as a drive on your computer, and only a cable can do that. When everything's ready, the Home page says **"P5 pen connected"**.



Says "not connected"?

Try another USB socket or another cable. Some cables can only charge and can't carry data. Then click **Rescan**.

2

Register your pen

Your P5 pen is covered by a **1-year warranty** from the date of purchase. Registering takes a minute and helps us look after you if anything goes wrong.

Scan the code, visit register.ponyabc.uk, or click **Register your pen** on the app's Home page.



Scan to register

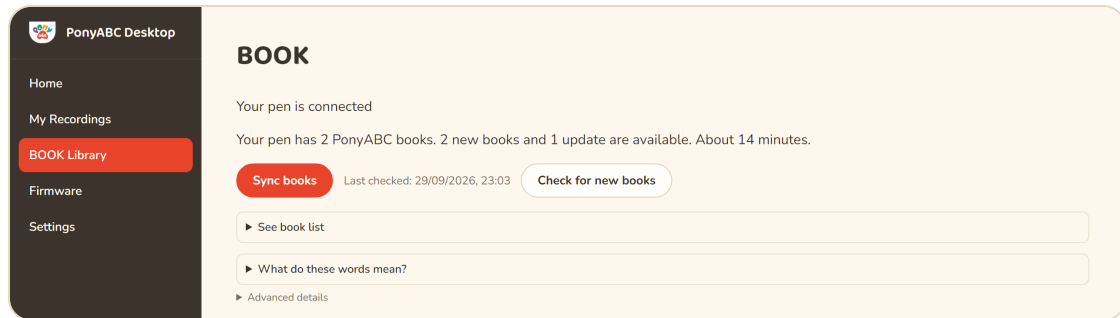
3

Adding books to your pen

Open **BOOK Library**. One friendly line tells you what's waiting for your pen, for example:

Your pen has 2 PonyABC books. 2 new books and 1 update are available. About 14 minutes.

Click **Sync books**. That's all there is to it — there's no need to pick books, and books can't be removed by accident.



While it works, keep the pen plugged in. The app shows **“Please don't unplug your pen”**, a progress bar and the time remaining.

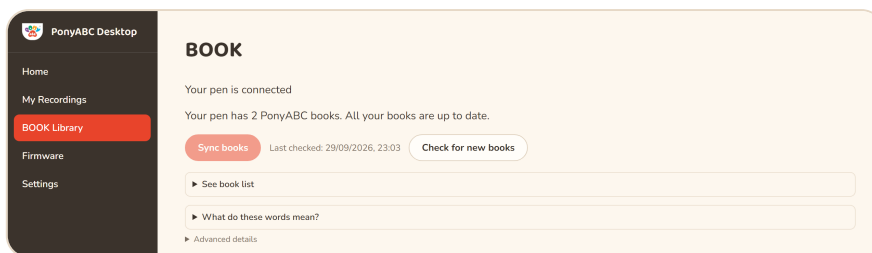


Why does it take a while?

The pen copies at about 1 MB a second, so a large book can take around 20 minutes. The app tells you how long before it starts and counts down as it goes. Your computer won't nod off in the meantime, so feel free to put the kettle on.

Already up to date?

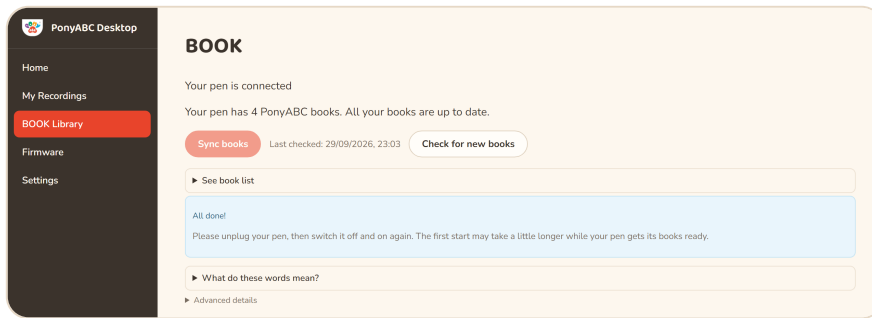
You'll see **“All your books are up to date.”** Nothing to do! Click **Check for new books** whenever you like.



4

Switching your pen off and on

When books have been added or updated, the app finishes with **“All done!”**.



1. Unplug the pen.
2. Switch it **off and on again**.
3. Leave it on until it responds. The first start after a sync takes a little longer while the pen gets its books ready — it's working, not stuck.

Until the pen has restarted, new or updated books may not play.



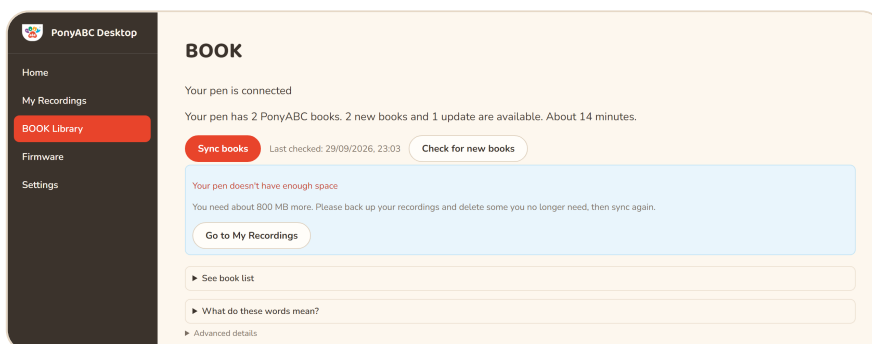
Why every time?

Whenever books are added or updated, your pen rebuilds its list of books the next time it starts. Switching it off and on makes sure every book plays properly.

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When your pen is running out of space

The app checks the space **before** it copies anything, so you're never left halfway. If there isn't enough room, it tells you exactly how much is needed.



1. Click **Go to My Recordings**.
2. Back up your recordings to this computer.
3. Delete the ones you no longer need from the pen. Your backed-up copies stay safely on the computer.
4. Come back and click **Sync books** again.



“We couldn't check your pen's free space”

Just unplug the pen, plug it in again and have another go. The app stops rather than guessing.

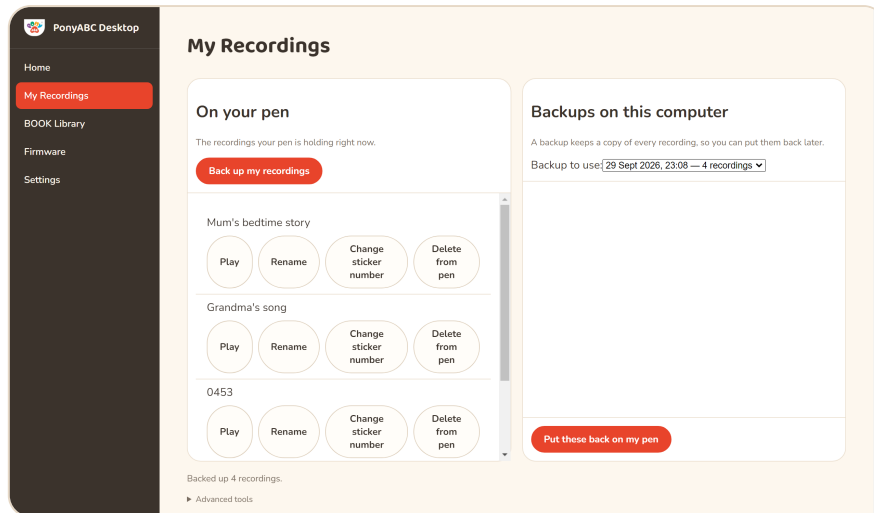
6

Your child's recordings

Open **My Recordings**. The recordings on your pen are on the left; the backups kept on this computer are on the right.

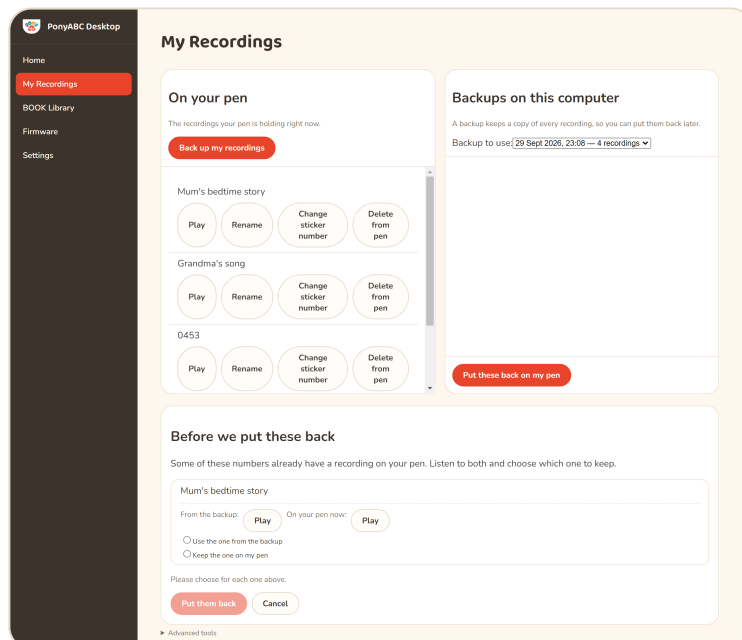
Back up my recordings

Click **Back up my recordings** to copy everything on the pen to this computer. It's a good idea to do this before deleting anything.



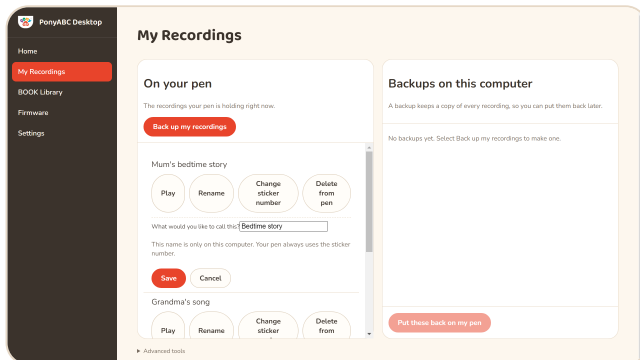
Put them back on the pen

Choose a backup and click **Put these back on my pen**. If a sticker already has a recording, the app lets you listen to both and choose which to keep — it never decides for you.



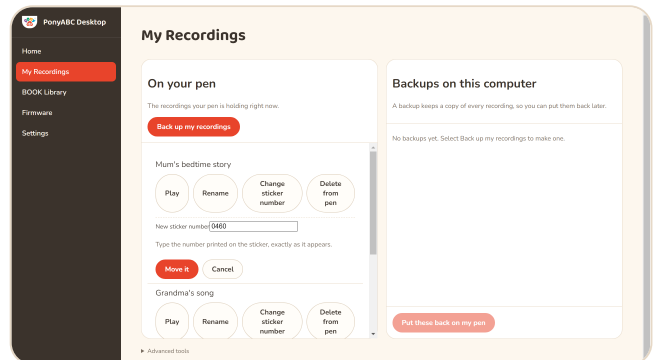
Rename

Give a recording a name you'll recognise, such as “Mum's bedtime story”. The name is kept on this computer; the pen always uses the sticker number.



Change sticker number

Move a recording to a different sticker. Type the number exactly as it's printed, including any zeros at the start.



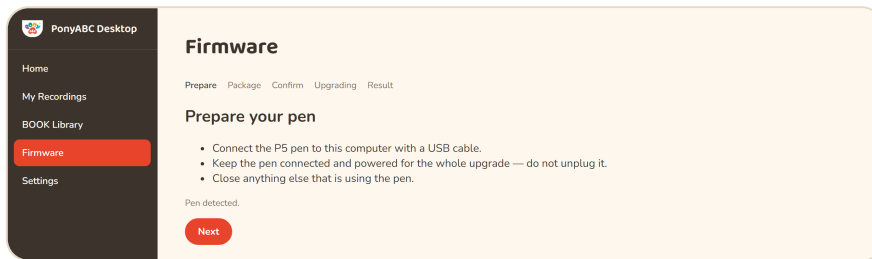
Delete from pen

Don't worry — the app always saves a copy to this computer first.

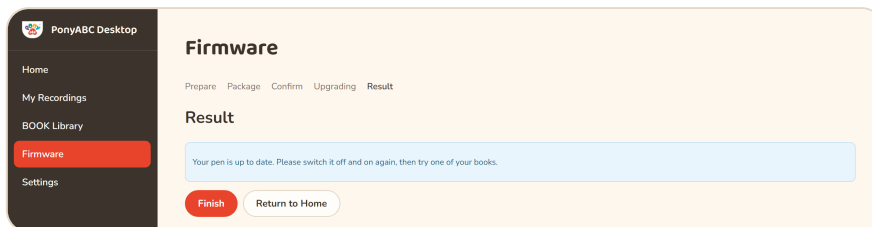
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Updating your pen (Windows)

Every so often, the pen's own software gets an update. Open **Firmware** and follow the steps — the app takes you through them one at a time.



- Windows will ask for your permission part of the way through. Please choose **Yes** — the update can't continue otherwise.
- **Please don't unplug the pen or close the app** while it's updating.
- When it has finished, switch the pen off and on, then try one of your books.



“The update did not start”



If something stops it before it begins — for example, choosing **No** at the Windows prompt — the app tells you plainly, and nothing on your pen has changed. Check it's still plugged in and try again.

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What the words mean

Your pen is connected	The app can see your pen and can put books on it.
On your pen / Up to date	This book is on your pen and ready to use. Nothing to do.
Update available	There's a newer version of this book. Sync books replaces it, keeping the old one as a backup first.
Not on your pen yet	A PonyABC book that Sync books will add.
Downloading...	The book is being copied to this computer, then to your pen.
Checking...	The app is checking this book. It only takes a moment.
Something's not right — open for help	This one needs a closer look. Nothing is wrong with your pen; open it for help, or contact us.
Other books (not from PonyABC)	Books that came from somewhere else. The app never changes them.
All done!	The sync has finished. Unplug the pen and switch it off and on.

You'll find the same list in the app under **What do these words mean?** on the BOOK Library page. **Advanced details** is there for our support team, if they ever ask you to open it.

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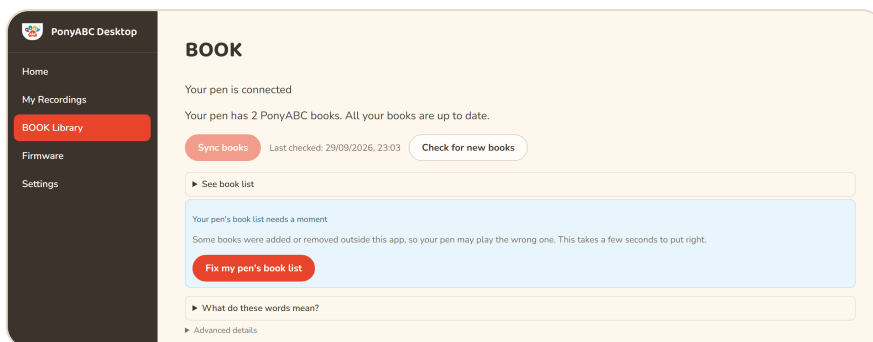
If something goes wrong

The app says my pen isn't connected.

Try the other end of the cable, a different USB socket and a different cable. Charge-only cables are very common and won't work.

A book I added doesn't play.

Switch the pen off and on and wait for it to finish starting. If it still won't play, open the app with the pen connected. If it offers **Fix my pen's book list**, click it, then restart the pen again.



It says it couldn't check my pen's free space.

Unplug the pen, plug it in again and try once more.

It has been copying for a long time.

That's usually normal — a large book takes about 20 minutes. The progress bar moves slowly, but it does move.

Something else?

Go to **Settings** → **Export diagnostics** and email us the file it saves. It's a record of what the app did, which helps us work out what happened.



We're here to help!

Scan a code with your phone camera, or type the address.



Official website



ponyabc.co.uk

The latest app, this guide in 8 languages, news and help.



Register your pen



register.ponyabc.uk

Activate your 1-year warranty. It only takes a minute.



Get the app



apps.microsoft.com/detail/9P544XC6B609

PonyABC Desktop, free from the Microsoft Store for Windows.

Still stuck? Drop us a line

marketing@ponyabc.co.uk

Tip: attach the file from **Settings** → **Export diagnostics** and we can help much faster.



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